BASELINE PROJECT PLAN (BPP)

DESIGN AND DEVELOPMENT OF A LIBRARY MANAGEMENT INFORMATION SYSTEM.

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1. INTRODUCTION.

A library plays an important role in providing students and staff with access to learning materials. However, managing library activities manually can be difficult, especially when dealing with many books and users.

This project proposes the development of a **Library Management Information System** to improve how library activities are carried out. The system will help manage books, register members, record borrowing and returning of books, and generate reports.

2. PROBLEM STATEMENT

Many libraries still depend on manual methods to manage their daily activities. These methods can lead to misplaced records, delays when searching for books, errors in recording borrowed materials, and difficulties tracking overdue books.

The proposed system will address these challenges by introducing a computerized system that makes library management faster, easier, and more reliable.

3. PROJECT OBJECTIVES

The main objective is to develop a computerized system that improves library operations.

The specific objectives are to:

- Create a system for recording and managing books.
- Register and manage library members.
- Record borrowing and returning of books.
- Make it easier to search for available books.
- Track overdue books and calculate fines.
- Generate reports on library activities.

4. PROPOSED SYSTEM

The proposed system will be a **Library Management Information System** designed to simplify library operations.

The system will have the following features:

- **Book management:** Adding, editing, and deleting book records.
- **Member registration:** Recording details of students and other library users.
- **Borrowing and returning:** Keeping records of borrowed and returned books.
- **Book searching:** Allowing users to search for books by title, author, or category.
- **Fine management:** Identifying overdue books and calculating applicable fines.
- **Report generation:** Producing reports on available books and borrowing activities.
- **User authentication:** Ensuring that only authorized users access the system.

System type: Transaction Processing System (TPS) with Management Information System (MIS) reporting features.

Development approach: Agile development approach, which allows the system to be developed in stages and improved through feedback.

5. FEASIBILITY STUDY

The feasibility study determines whether the project can realistically be completed.

5.1 Economic Feasibility

The project is economically feasible because the benefits of reducing paperwork, saving time, and improving record management are expected to justify the development costs.

5.2 Technical Feasibility

The system can be developed using available computers, programming tools, database software, and internet connectivity. The required technical skills can also be obtained.

5.3 Operational Feasibility

The system will be easy for librarians and other authorized users to operate. Training will be provided to help users understand how it works.

5.4 Schedule Feasibility

The project is expected to take approximately twelve weeks. The work will be divided into stages to ensure that activities are completed within the planned period.

5.5 Legal and Contractual Feasibility

The project will follow relevant data protection requirements. User information will only be accessed by authorized individuals.

5.6 Political Feasibility

The project is expected to receive support from library management, staff, and students because it will improve service delivery and reduce manual work.

6. PROJECT DELIVERABLES

- The main deliverables will include:

- A completed Library Management Information System.
- A database containing book and member records.
- A user login and authentication module.
- A borrowing and returning module.
- A book searching and reporting module.
- System documentation.

- User training and a final project report.

7. PROJECT IMPLEMENTATION TIMELINE

Table 1: Project Implementation Timeline

Activity	Duration	Expected Period
Project planning	1 week	Week 1
Requirements gathering	2 weeks	Weeks 2–3
System design	2 weeks	Weeks 4–5
System Development	3 weeks	Weeks 6–8
System testing	1 week	Week 9
Implementation	1 week	Week 10
User training	1 week	Week 11
Final review and documentation	1 week	Week 12

8. PROJECT MILESTONES AND DELIVERABLES

Table 2: Project Milestones

Milestone	Expected Deliverable
Planning completed	Approved project plan
Requirements completed	Requirements document
System design completed	System design documentation
Development completed	Working system
Testing completed	Tested system
Implementation completed	Installed system
Project completed	Final report and documentation

9. PROJECT BUDGET

The estimated budget for developing and implementing the Library Management Information System is **Ksh 1,000,000**.

Table 3: Project Budget Breakdown

Item	Estimated Cost (Ksh)
Software development and programming	250,000
Hardware and equipment	180,000
Database design and development	100,000
Networking and internet	80,000
System testing and quality assurance	75,000
User training and support	60,000
Documentation and project management	70,000

System installation and implementation	65,000
Maintenance and contingency	120,000
TOTAL	**1,000,000**

10. PROJECT STAKEHOLDERS

The project will involve different people who will contribute to its success.

Table 4: Project Stakeholders and Responsibilities

Stakeholder	Responsibility
Project Manager	Planning and coordinating project activities
System Developer	Designing and developing the system
Database Administrator	Managing the system database
Librarian	Providing requirements and testing the system
Students	Using the system to search and borrow books
University Management	Providing support and approving resources

11. PROJECT REPORTING SCHEDULE

Regular reporting will help monitor progress and identify challenges early.

Table 5: Project Reporting Schedule

Report	Frequency	Responsible Person
Progress report	Weekly	Project Manager
Development report	After each development stage	System Developer
Testing report	After testing	Testing Team
Budget report	Monthly	Project Manager
Final project report	At completion	Project Manager

12. EXPECTED OUTCOMES

After successful implementation, the project is expected to achieve the following:

- Faster searching and retrieval of books.
- Improved accuracy of library records.
- Reduced paperwork and manual processes.
- Better tracking of borrowed and returned books.
- Improved service delivery to students and staff.
- Easier preparation of library reports.

13. CONCLUSION

The proposed Library Management Information System will help improve the management of library activities by reducing manual work and making information easier to access. The system will provide a more organized way of managing books, members, borrowing, and returning activities.

With proper planning, sufficient resources, and cooperation from stakeholders, the project can be successfully developed and implemented.